



IN CONTEXT

GENRE

Crime, drama

DIRECTOR

Nuri Bilge Ceylan

WRITERS

Ebru Ceylan, Nuri Bilge Ceylan, Ercan Kesal

STARS

Muhammet Uzuner, Yilmaz Erdogan, Taner Birsil, Firat Tanis

BEFORE

1997 Nuri Bilge Ceylan's critically acclaimed debut feature *The Town* is a dreamlike examination of childhood and family.

2008 In Ceylan's *Three Monkeys*, a politician offers a family money to cover up a hit-and-run accident.

AFTER

2014 *Winter Sleep* earns Ceylan the Palme d'Or at the Cannes Film Festival.

EVERYONE PAYS FOR THE THINGS THEY DO

ONCE UPON A TIME IN ANATOLIA / 2011

Police work and all that comes with upholding the law has long been a source of fascination in movies. The police represent order, and for the common good they must endure terrible things on our behalf. Turkish director Nuri Bilge Ceylan's brooding, tragic movie *Once Upon a Time in Anatolia* is a tale of cops, doctors, and lawyers as they search through the night for the body of a murder victim. Stripping out the artificial glamour and excitement that define these professions in most movies, the movie presents their work as a punishing journey in an endless night that is filled with frustration, tension, and very little glory. Here, the officials who uphold law and order are heroes not because they always catch the bad guy, but because they give up a part of their humanity so that we don't have to.



Eschewing cop-show clichés, Nuri Bilge Ceylan's *Once Upon a Time in Anatolia* portrays the drudgery of police work with raw, unflinching honesty.

The policemen and lawyers in *Once Upon a Time in Anatolia* are forced to deal with the horrors they witness while also fulfilling the demands of their respective bureaucracies. Unable to express their true reactions to what they see, they are allowed very little catharsis. Police officer Naci (Yilmaz Erdogan) is repeatedly rebuked for his impulsive reactions to setbacks. When a body is found,

“Nobody just dies because they said they would.”

Cemal / Once Upon a Time in Anatolia